Incident Report – Brute Force Attack (T1110)

Analyst: Yathin Reddy Taii | Date: 13 Oct 2026 | Lab Environment

Summary (revised, plainer):

On 13 October 2026, repeated failed login attempts were observed against a Windows endpoint (LAPTOP-9EMLTGRK) from host 192.168.56.102. The attempts targeted the local account secuser over SMB. Five failed logins (Event ID 4625) were followed by one successful login (Event ID 4624) within a 2-minute window. The activity matches MITRE ATT&CK technique T1110 (Brute Force).

Timeline

Time (UTC)	Event	Source
02:58:xx – 02:59:46	5x failed SMB login attempts (Event ID 4625), account secuser, source 192.168.56.102	Windows Security Log / Splunk / Wazuh
02:59:5x	1x successful login (Event ID 4624), same account, same source	Windows Security Log / Splunk / Wazuh
Total window	~2 minutes	—
Prior activity (recon)	Nmap port scan from 192.168.56.102 revealed open ports 135, 139, 445 (RPC/NetBIOS/SMB)	Wireshark capture

Root Cause / Technical Analysis

The attacker used smbclient from a Linux host (Kali, 192.168.56.102) to attempt SMB authentication against the Windows endpoint using the local account secuser. Multiple incorrect password attempts were made in quick succession, followed by a correct password, indicating a brute-force or password-guessing attempt rather than a single mistaken login.

A custom Wazuh correlation rule (ID 100010) was written to automatically detect this pattern (5+ failed logins within 120 seconds from the same source). Initial testing showed the rule did not trigger. Root cause: the rule used <same_source_ip/>, which checks Wazuh's generic srcip field — but Windows Security event data stores the source IP under data.win.eventdata.ipAddress, a different field. This was confirmed by inspecting the raw Wazuh alert JSON for the triggering event. The rule was corrected to use <same_field>win.eventdata.ipAddress</same_field> instead.

Independently, a Splunk correlation search was built and confirmed working, detecting 3 separate brute-force windows (6 failed logins each) across the attack timeframe.

IOCs & ATT&CK Mapping

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs):

Type	Value
Attacker IP	192.168.56.102
Targeted account	secuser
Targeted host	LAPTOP-9EMLTGRK (192.168.56.1)
Protocol	SMB (ports 445/139)
Event IDs	4625 (failure), 4624 (success)
Tool used by attacker	smbclient

MITRE ATT&CK Mapping:

Tactic	Technique	ID
Reconnaissance	Network Service Scanning (Nmap scan of 135/139/445)	T1046
Credential Access	Brute Force	T1110